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Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)

Explanatory Guide with User Instruction Elements

Version: 1.0

Last Updated: June 2026

Applicable For: General Users / Employees / Customers

Document Purpose

This guide explains **Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)**, its importance, and how to use it to secure your account.

Key Topics Covered

- What is 2FA?
- How 2FA Works (SMS, Email, Authenticator Apps)
- Why 2FA is Important
- Step-by-Step Setup & Verification

Notes

- For support, contact: gids@gmail.com
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1. Introduction

1.1 What is Second-Factor Authentication (2FA)?

Second-Factor Authentication (2FA) is a security management system that enhances account protection by adding a second security identification. While the primary security measure is the username and password, 2FA provides an additional layer of defence. This guide aims to explain 2FA to general users.

1.2 Examples of 2FA

- Google Authenticator
- Email verification
- Biometric verification: Face recognition, fingerprint

2. How Does 2FA Work?

Login processes vary depending on the platform. However, 2FAs follow a similar procedure:

A. First Factor

The user is required to log in by entering the login credentials which are:

- **Username/ Email**
- **Password**

B. Second Factor

If the credentials are recognised, the user is requested to authenticate the account using:

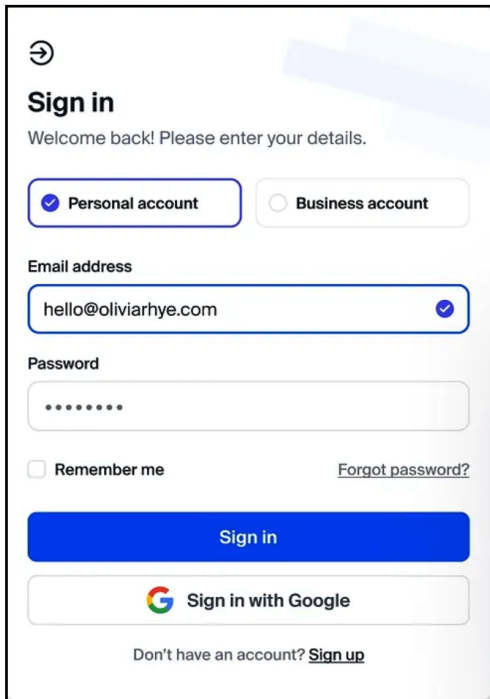
- **SMS code:** A one-time code is sent via text.
- **Email verification:** A link or code is sent to the user's email.
- **Google Authenticator:** User enters a code from their Authenticator app.
- **Device lock:** Biometric or device unlock method (e.g., fingerprint or PIN).

C. Verification

The user's account is verified and is granted access. This only takes a few seconds.

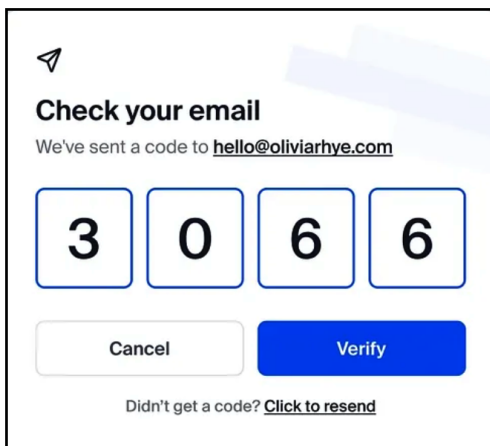
An example of 2FA using an email would progress like this:

1. The user logs in using a username and password.

A screenshot of a web application's sign-in page. At the top left is a circular arrow icon. Below it is the heading "Sign in" and a subtext "Welcome back! Please enter your details." There are two radio buttons: "Personal account" (selected) and "Business account". Below these is a text input field for "Email address" containing "hello@oliviarhye.com" with a blue checkmark on the right. Underneath is a "Password" field with masked dots. Below the password field are two links: "Remember me" (with an unchecked checkbox) and "Forgot password?". A large blue "Sign in" button is centered below the links. Below that is a "Sign in with Google" button featuring the Google logo. At the bottom, it says "Don't have an account? [Sign up](#)".

Screen prompting the user to enter email address and password.

2. The system emails the user a one-time code.

A screenshot of a "Check your email" screen. At the top left is a paper plane icon. Below it is the heading "Check your email" and subtext "We've sent a code to [hello@oliviarhye.com](#)". In the center are four square boxes, each containing a digit of the verification code: 3, 0, 6, and 6. Below these boxes are two buttons: a "Cancel" button and a blue "Verify" button. At the bottom, it says "Didn't get a code? [Click to resend](#)".

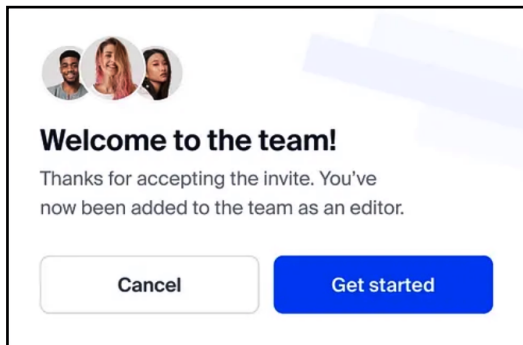
A screen displaying spaces for verification code input.

3. The system verifies the account.



A screen displaying a successful account verification.

4. The user gains full access.



A screen displaying a successful login.

You can find more 2FA image examples [here](#).

3. Why is 2FA Important?

- **Enhanced Security** – Even if a password is compromised, the second factor blocks unauthorized access.
- **User Confidence** – Users are assured of better protection against hacking attempts.

4. Setup & Troubleshooting

A. How do I enable 2FA on my account?

1. Go to **Account Settings** → **Security**.

2. Select **Enable 2FA** and choose your method (SMS, app, etc.).
3. Follow the prompts to verify.

B. What if I don't receive my 2FA code?

- Check your spam/junk folder (for email codes).
- Ensure your phone has signal (for SMS).
- Use a backup method (e.g., authenticator app).
- Click "**Resend Code**" or contact support.

C. Can I use 2FA without a phone?

Yes! Use an **authenticator app** (works offline) or **email-based 2FA**.

4. Summary

Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) is a reliable security management procedure that involves a few steps to provide an additional layer of defence for accounts and ensure a secure login for all users